Sophie Messer

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SUMMARY

Human-centered design student passionate about creating accessible and inclusive designs. Experienced in user research, prototyping, data analysis, and creating impactful, practical designs.

EDUCATION

Imperial | MSc Design with Behavioural Science
Current Student | Expected Graduation September 2027

University of Washington | Major: Human Centered Design & Engineering, Data Science | Minors: Data Science and Informatics
Dean's List, GPA: 3.57 | Graduated 2026

- *College Leadership:* SWE Family Lead | Engineers Without Borders | GoBabyGo Leadership Team, Communications
- *Relevant Courses*: Calculus with Analytic Geometry II–III, Engineering Exploration, Computer Programming, Intellectual Foundations, Technical Communication, Intro to Logic, Current Topics in Psychology, Visualization and CAD, Biopsychology, Social Media Ethics, Foundations of Human Centered Design I–II, Interactive Systems Design & Technology, Data Science Foundations, Intro to User Research, Research Methods, Visual Communication in HCDE, Inclusive Design Engineering, Under Experience Prototyping, Organizational Teamwork, Concepts in Human-Computer Interaction, Product Management, Information Visualization
- ***Capstone Project with Jeppesen Foreflight:***
  - Surveyed 26 GA pilots and conducted 9 interviews to identify needs for peer knowledge-sharing.
  - Developed 25+ concepts, 5 usability tests, and 3 prototype iterations to refine a community-based experience.
  - Designed a final mobile prototype with airport tips, pilot profiles, and forums.

Design & Prototyping: Figma, Canva, SolidWorks, Computer-Aided Design (CAD), 3D Printing
User Experience & Research: User Interviewing, Affinity Mapping, Prototyping, Wireframing, Usability Testing, Journey Mapping, Persona Development, Interaction Design, Inclusive Design, Data Communications, Marketing
Programming & Data: Python, Java, HTML, CSS, GitHub

EXPERIENCE

Contract UX Designer October 2025 - March 2026
Sensigo | *Remote*

- Continued work on designing Sensigo's AI web product and app.
- Prototyping and conducting user research to improve user experience across all platforms.

UX Design Intern June 2025 - August 2025
Sensigo | *San Carlos, California*

- Redesign Sensigo's AI web product and developed web app to help auto technicians.
- Designed and produced visual assets for marketing campaigns and brand communications.

London Study Abroad August 2025 - September 2025
HCDE Study Abroad | *London*

- Focused on embodied and experiential design using skills like abductive reasoning and rapid prototyping.
- Designed interactive designs exploring human and nonhuman experiences of space and coordination.

RESEARCH

Undergraduate Researcher January 2025 - March 2025
2025 STEM Alternative Spring Break | *Seattle, Washington*

- Led HCDE workshops at Neah Bay High School for the tribal community, developing curriculum and practicing culturally responsive teaching while engaging with students and educators.
- Tested and refined this curriculum across middle and high schools in the greater Seattle area to ensure clarity, accessibility, and community relevance.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY OUTREACH

Leadership Team, Communications September 2025 - June 2026
GoBabyGo | *Seattle, Washington*

- Chosen to manage the Instagram and update the website to better reach families and community partners
- Attended builds and sharing accessible information on events so more families can connect

SWE Family Lead September 2025 - June 2026
SWE | *Seattle, Washington*

- Lead a SWE Family, organizing inclusive social events for the community to foster connections and mentoring.
- Giving back to SWE community, building opportunities for members to explore shared interests, and developing hobbies.